# AI Prompt Engineering Cheatsheet (2026)

## 50 Copy-Paste Prompts That Actually Work

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## THE CRAFT FRAMEWORK

Great prompts follow CRAFT:

**C**ontext — Set the scene
**R**ole — Assign an expert persona
**A**ction — Be specific about what you want
**F**ormat — Specify the output format
**T**one — Set the voice

**Bad prompt:** "Write me a marketing email"

**CRAFT prompt:** "You are a direct-response copywriter with 15 years of experience (Role). I'm launching an AI automation toolkit for small business owners (Context). Write a 200-word cold email that highlights 3 specific time-saving benefits and ends with a soft CTA to book a demo (Action). Use short paragraphs, one idea per sentence (Format). Professional but conversational, like talking to a smart friend (Tone)."

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## BUSINESS PROMPTS (10)

### 1. Competitive Analysis

> "Analyze [competitor] as if you're a McKinsey consultant briefing a CEO. Cover: positioning, pricing strategy, strengths, weaknesses, and 3 specific opportunities they're missing that I could exploit. My company does [your description]."

### 2. Revenue Model Brainstorm

> "You're a startup advisor who's helped 50 companies reach $1M ARR. I have [your product/audience]. Generate 7 revenue models ranked by: speed to first dollar, scalability, and defensibility. For each, give a 30-day action plan."

### 3. Customer Persona Builder

> "Create 3 detailed customer personas for [your product]. For each: name, age, job title, annual income, biggest frustration, where they hang out online, what they've already tried, and the exact words they'd use to describe their problem."

### 4. Pricing Strategy

> "You're a pricing strategist. My product is [description], targeting [audience]. Current price: [price]. Analyze: am I leaving money on the table? Suggest 3 pricing structures (tiered, usage-based, freemium) with specific numbers and psychological justification for each."

### 5. Business Plan One-Pager

> "Write a 1-page business plan for [idea]. Include: problem (2 sentences), solution (2 sentences), target market (size + who), revenue model, competitive advantage, 90-day milestones, and the one metric that matters most."

### 6. Partnership Pitch

> "Draft a partnership proposal email to [company type]. I offer [your value]. I want [what you need]. Make it impossible to say no by leading with what's in it for them. Max 150 words."

### 7. Investor Update Template

> "Create a monthly investor update template for a [stage] startup. Include: key metrics table, wins (top 3), challenges (honest), cash position, burn rate, runway, asks (specific help needed). Keep it under 500 words."

### 8. Sales Script

> "Write a 2-minute cold call script for selling [product] to [audience]. Include: pattern interrupt opener, 2 qualifying questions, pain agitation, value bridge, and soft close. Assume they're busy and skeptical."

### 9. SWOT Analysis

> "Conduct a SWOT analysis for [business] entering [market]. Be brutally honest — don't sugarcoat weaknesses. For each threat, suggest a specific mitigation strategy. For each opportunity, suggest an action I can take this week."

### 10. Churn Reduction

> "You're a customer success expert. My [product type] has [X]% monthly churn. Top cancellation reasons: [list them]. Design a 5-step churn reduction playbook with specific email templates, intervention triggers, and win-back sequences."

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## CONTENT CREATION PROMPTS (10)

### 11. Blog Post Outline

> "Create a blog post outline for '[topic]' targeting [keyword]. Structure: hook (surprising stat or question), 5-7 H2 sections, each with a key takeaway, FAQ section (5 questions for featured snippets), and CTA. Optimize for both readers and SEO."

### 12. Social Media Thread

> "Write a 7-tweet thread about [topic]. Tweet 1: bold claim or surprising stat (hook). Tweets 2-6: one actionable insight each with a specific example. Tweet 7: summary + CTA. Each tweet under 280 chars. No hashtags."

### 13. YouTube Script

> "Write a 5-minute YouTube script about [topic]. Structure: 15-second hook (start with the payoff), problem setup (30 sec), 3 main points with examples (3.5 min), recap + CTA (1 min). Include B-roll suggestions in brackets."

### 14. Email Newsletter

> "Write a weekly newsletter edition about [topic] for [audience]. Style: conversational, opinionated, useful. Structure: one big idea (2 paragraphs), 3 curated links with one-line commentary, one actionable tip, sign-off with personality. 400 words max."

### 15. LinkedIn Post

> "Write a LinkedIn post about [topic/lesson learned]. Use the hook-story-lesson format. First line must stop the scroll. Include line breaks for readability. End with a question to drive comments. No emojis. No hashtags. 150-200 words."

### 16. Product Description

> "Write a product description for [product] targeting [buyer persona]. Lead with the transformation, not features. Include: headline (benefit-driven), 3 bullet points (outcome-focused), social proof line, urgency element, CTA. Under 200 words."

### 17. Case Study

> "Write a case study about [client/result]. Structure: the situation (what was broken), the approach (what we did differently), the results (specific numbers), the key insight (what others can learn). Make it readable in 3 minutes."

### 18. Podcast Questions

> "Generate 15 interview questions for [guest name/expertise]. Mix: 3 icebreakers, 5 expertise-deep-dives, 3 contrarian/spicy takes, 2 practical takeaways, 2 rapid-fire. Avoid generic questions — make them specific to their known work."

### 19. Content Repurposing

> "I have this [content type]: [paste content]. Repurpose it into: 1 LinkedIn post, 3 tweets, 1 email newsletter paragraph, 1 Instagram caption, and 5 pull quotes. Maintain the core message but adapt tone for each platform."

### 20. Headline Generator

> "Generate 20 headline variations for '[topic]' using these frameworks: How-to, Listicle, Question, Contrarian, Data-driven, Fear-based, Curiosity gap, Social proof, Time-bound, Comparison. Mark your top 3 picks and explain why they'll get clicks."

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# PRODUCTIVITY PROMPTS (10)

### 21. Meeting Summary

> "Summarize this meeting transcript into: key decisions made, action items (who/what/when), open questions, and follow-up needed. Flag anything that seems like scope creep or a potential blocker. [paste transcript]"

### 22. Email Drafts

> "Write 3 versions of a reply to this email: [paste email]. Version 1: agreeable and accommodating. Version 2: firm but diplomatic pushback. Version 3: asking for more information before committing. Each under 100 words."

### 23. Weekly Planning

> "Help me plan my week. My top 3 priorities are: [list them]. I have [X] hours available. Meetings: [list them]. Create a time-blocked schedule that protects deep work, groups meetings, and includes buffer time. Flag if my priorities don't fit my available hours."

### 24. Decision Framework

> "I need to decide between [option A] and [option B]. Ask me 5 clarifying questions first, then create a weighted decision matrix with criteria you'd recommend. Score each option and give your recommendation with reasoning."

### 25. Process Documentation

> "Document this process: [describe it]. Write it so a new hire could follow it on day 1. Include: prerequisites, step-by-step instructions, common mistakes, troubleshooting section, and who to contact if stuck."

### 26. Delegation Brief

> "Create a delegation brief for [task]. Include: objective (what success looks like), context (why this matters), constraints (budget/timeline/must-haves), resources available, check-in points, and quality criteria. Written for someone who's never done this before."

### 27. Performance Review Self-Assessment

> "Help me write a self-assessment for my performance review. My role: [title]. Key accomplishments: [list them]. Areas I struggled: [list them]. Write it honestly but strategically — highlight impact, quantify results, and frame growth areas as forward-looking goals."

### 28. Negotiation Prep

> "I'm negotiating [what] with [who]. My ideal outcome: [X]. My walk-away point: [Y]. Help me prepare: 3 opening positions, anticipated objections with responses, 2 creative trades I can offer, and a BATNA assessment."

### 29. Learning Plan

> "Create a 30-day learning plan for [skill]. I can dedicate [X] hours/week. I'm currently at [level]. Include: specific resources (free preferred), daily/weekly milestones, a project to build by day 30, and how to measure my progress."

### 30. Feedback Template

> "Help me give constructive feedback to [person/role] about [issue]. Use the SBI framework (Situation-Behavior-Impact). Make it specific, actionable, and kind. Include what I want to see instead and offer to help."

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## MARKETING PROMPTS (10)

### 31. Ad Copy

> "Write 5 Facebook ad variations for [product] targeting [audience]. Each needs: headline (under 40 chars), primary text (under 125 chars), description. Test angles: pain point, aspiration, social proof, curiosity, urgency."

### 32. Landing Page Copy

> "Write landing page copy for [product/offer]. Structure: hero headline + subhead, 3 benefit blocks, social proof section, FAQ (5 questions), final CTA. Voice: [describe]. Primary conversion goal: [what you want them to do]."

### 33. Email Sequence

> "Design a 5-email welcome sequence for new subscribers to [business]. Email 1: instant value delivery. Email 2: origin story + credibility. Email 3: biggest mistake in [niche]. Email 4: case study/proof. Email 5: soft sell. Include subject lines."

### 34. SEO Keyword Clusters

> "I'm building content for [niche]. Generate 5 keyword clusters. For each cluster: 1 pillar page topic, 5 supporting blog post topics, estimated search intent (informational/commercial/transactional), and internal linking strategy."

### 35. Referral Program

> "Design a referral program for [product]. Include: incentive structure (both sides), messaging templates (email, social, in-app), gamification elements, tracking mechanism, and launch announcement. Budget: [X]."

### 36. Product Launch Plan

> "Create a 14-day product launch plan for [product]. Include: pre-launch (days 1-7), launch day, post-launch (days 8-14). For each day: specific actions, content to publish, channels to hit, and metrics to track."

### 37. Competitor Positioning

> "Compare [my product] vs [competitor 1] and [competitor 2]. Create a positioning matrix showing where each wins. Then write a 'Why us' section that highlights our unique advantage without bashing competitors."

### 38. Testimonial Request

> "Write 3 email templates to request testimonials from happy customers. Version 1: quick quote request (2 min ask). Version 2: detailed case study interview request. Version 3: video testimonial request. Include specific prompting questions that get quotable responses."

### 39. A/B Test Ideas

> "Generate 10 A/B test ideas for [my website/product]. For each: what to test, hypothesis, expected impact (high/med/low), implementation difficulty, and how to measure success. Prioritize by effort-to-impact ratio."

### 40. Brand Voice Guide

> "Create a brand voice guide for [business]. Include: 3 voice attributes with examples, do's and don'ts, vocabulary list (words we use vs. words we avoid), example copy for 5 scenarios (error message, celebration, onboarding, support, marketing), and tone shifts by context."

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## CAREER & PERSONAL (10)

### 41. Resume Bullet Points

> "Rewrite these resume bullet points using the XYZ formula (Accomplished [X] by doing [Y], resulting in [Z]). Make each one quantified and outcome-focused: [paste your bullet points]"

### 42. Cover Letter

> "Write a cover letter for [job title] at [company]. My relevant experience: [list it]. Their job requirements: [paste them]. Make it specific to this company (not generic), under 300 words, and end with confidence, not desperation."

### 43. Interview Prep

> "I'm interviewing for [role] at [company]. Generate 10 likely questions and optimal answers using the STAR method. Include 3 questions I should ask them that show strategic thinking about their business."

### 44. Salary Negotiation

> "I received an offer for [role] at [X salary]. Market rate for this role in [location] with [Y years experience] is [range]. Draft a negotiation email that asks for [target] while maintaining enthusiasm for the role. Include 3 justification points."

### 45. Side Project Validator

> "I want to build [side project idea]. Play devil's advocate: give me 5 reasons this will fail. Then give me 5 ways to validate demand this weekend without building anything. Be honest, not encouraging."

### 46. Networking Message

> "Write a LinkedIn connection request to [person/role]. I want to [goal]. Make it personal (reference something specific about their work), brief

> (under 300 chars), and make it easy for them to say yes."

### 47. Personal Brand Statement

> "Create a personal brand statement for me. I'm a [role] who specializes in [what]. I help [who] achieve [outcome]. My unique angle is [what makes you different]. Write it in 3 versions: 1-sentence, elevator pitch (30 sec), and LinkedIn About section."

### 48. Skill Gap Analysis

> "I'm a [current role] wanting to become a [target role] in [timeframe]. Analyze the skill gap: what I likely have, what I'm missing, and a prioritized learning plan. Be specific about which skills have the highest ROI for this transition."

### 49. Burnout Recovery Plan

> "I'm experiencing burnout from [situation]. Create a realistic 2-week recovery plan that doesn't require quitting my job. Include: daily micro-practices (under 10 min), boundary-setting scripts for work, energy management strategies, and warning signs to watch for."

### 50. Annual Review

> "Help me conduct a personal annual review. Ask me 10 powerful questions about [this year], then help me set 3 goals for next year using the 'one word, one metric, one habit' framework."

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## GET THE FULL TOOLKIT

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